

into the future, the summit had CEO of Saudi Data and AI Authority (SDAIA), Dr. Majid Al Tuwaijri to discuss an ecosystem approach to AI adoption.

PIONEER AI INNOVATIONS TO BENEFIT THE WORLD

The International Telecommunication Union (ITU) and SDAIA signed an agreement to create a set of Global AI Readiness Frameworks for key socio-economic domains such as e.g. health and smart mobility that could help countries adopt best practices in their use of AI necessary for countries to harness AI's full potential. The AI Readiness Framework will be developed by the ITU, with funding support from SDAIA, and will enable a variety of tools and activities to explore national AI best practices and countries' readiness.

H.E. Dr. Abdullah bin Sharaf Alghamdi, SDAIA President remarked, "We truly believe that nations should collaborate and exchange as much of the AI know-how and best practices as possible to maximize the efficiency and effectiveness of national efforts."

Following a Ministerial roundtable at the Global AI Summit, member states of the Digital Cooperation Organization (DCO) agreed to adopt the Riyadh AI Call for Action Declaration (RAICA), which seeks to use AI technology to benefit people, communities, nations, and the world as a whole.

The declaration was signed by all members of DCO including Bahrain, Cyprus, Djibouti, Kuwait, Morocco, Nigeria, Oman, Pakistan, Jordan, Rwanda, and Saudi Arabia. The call to action aims to advance the DCO's commitment to identify and address

present, emerging and future humanitarian issues in the field of AI. The declaration highlights the different ways AI can be used as a tool to benefit the lives of millions of people around the world by improving the quality of work, developing better designed public policies and nurturing efficiencies into the ecosystem.

SDAIA and IBM signed a strategic agreement to drive adoption of artificial intelligence in the carbon capture and industrial domains across the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia. According to the agreement, SDAIA, the Ministry of Energy and IBM will use artificial intelligence technology to detect, map, and eventually reduce carbon emissions across the country. Dr. Majid Al-Tuwaijri, the CEO for the National Center for AI, said, "This agreement with IBM will contribute to creating opportunities by addressing key challenges in the circular carbon economy, petrochemical and industrial domains." Google Cloud, in joint efforts with the Saudi Data & Artificial Intelligence Authority (SDAIA), Ministry of Environment, Water and Agriculture (MEWA) and Climate Engine have launched the Earth Observation and Science Program. Using that technology and AI, the program will provide sustainability solutions for the region.

WHILE BOOSTING LOCAL AI ECOSYSTEM

Of course, the Summit attracted a lot of local investment and interest within Saudi companies pushing the frontier of responsible AI adoption. To that end, Saudi Aramco signed an agreement valued at \$250 million with Beyond

Limits, a California-based artificial intelligence technology company, to build a global AI corridor, the oil behemoth announced at an industry event in Riyadh last week. The global AI corridor would create an ecosystem in the Kingdom by commercialising complex AI solutions, training Saudi talent and supporting Saudi startups.

KAUST President Tony Chan announced a new partnership with Saudi Data and AI Authority (SDAIA) as part of his address at the Summit. "There is enormous demand for AI courses and training in the KSA, and KAUST will take a leadership position on that, in partnership with SDAIA," said Chan. KAUST Academy is creating an educational program that will nurture the next generation of Saudi talent with its series of hands-on training courses in artificial intelligence, among other themed areas. The Saudi Company for Artificial Intelligence (SCAI), has signed an MoU with the Saudi Technology and Security Comprehensive Control Company (Tahakom). The two parties will collaborate to develop the AI infrastructure and super-computing capabilities necessary to power the next generation of AI applications.

INSIGHTS BY AI EXPERTS

We spoke to a lot of field experts that are being disrupted by AI applications – everything from health and medicine to ethics and beyond. The overall sense we got from the second edition of Global AI Summit organized in Saudi Arabia is that AI cannot just be a conversation dominated by tech experts and computer science nerds anymore, especially when it has far-reaching implications on commerce, safety and security of everyone from individual users to nation states. There's a need for more nuance in how AI evolves across various sectors from now onwards into the near future.

In the pages that follow, we try to give you various perspectives on individuals and organizations that are working on the cutting edge of AI progress. We give you a sense of their challenges and opportunities, so you can better understand what are some of the ways AI innovation is happening across the world. **[1]**

